Nakul Banka

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Education

University of California, Berkeley **Expected Graduation: May 2030**
Bachelor of Arts in Economics, Bachelor of Science in Data Science *Berkeley, CA*

Bellarmine College Preparatory **August 2022 - May 2026**
***Relevant Coursework**: AP Statistics, AP Calculus BC, AP CSA Economics Honors, Intro to Business.*

Experience

Media and Marketing Intern **Feburary 2025 – May 2026**
Muwekma Ohlone Tribe *San Jose, CA*

- Contributed to efforts earning $500k+ in non-profit grants supporting federal recognition efforts.
- Worked with Rep. Ro Khanna, Eric Swallwell, Emily Randall; Sen. Alex Padilla to introduce letter of support in order to grant federal recognition rights for the indigenous Muwekma Ohlone Tribe.

Venture Capital Fellow **October 2025 – May 2026**
Pier 70 Ventures *San Jose, CA*

- Researched companies focusing on Social Determinants of Health(SDOH) and Health Equity.
- Created impact report of 17 portoflio long venture capital fund, detaling numeric social impact, aimed to prove impact to potential LPs, worked directly alongside managing partner Preetha Ram.

Venture Capital Research Intern **April 2025 – October 2025**
3i Partners *San Jose, CA*

- Analyzed funding/growth metrics(4+ startups) leading to undisclosed investment from VC firm.
- Evaluated investment strategy for India-based sustainability company TAN 90(cold chain solutions)

Independent Researcher **July 2024 – February 2025**
Under Prof. Nikunj Kapadia, Dept. of Finance, University of Massachusets, Amherst *San Jose, CA*

- Analyzed and published(10+ pg) about impact of media/portfolio impact on the collapse of SVB.
- Conducted interview with VP of Finance, Andrew McCarty, analyzing pre/post-collapse hour-to-hour decisions eventually leading to acquisition from First Citizens Bank admist FDIC bailout.

Research Intern **May 2025 – November 2025**
University of Southern California, Marshall School of Business *Los Angeles, CA*

- Analyzed company potential strategy pivot(SaaS/Platform) in 10+ page growth analysis report.
- Worked under Professor Arvind Bhambri, meeting with 5+ executive members of workflow and healthcare education company Exxat to determine growth strategy for SaaS vs. Platform models.

Debate Coach **May 2026 – Present**
Golden State Academy, Brooks Debate Institute, Stratford *San Jose, CA*

- Coached/Taught over 150 students using mock debats, drills, topic analysis, and research lectures
- Coached 6+ middle school teams to top 8/60-70+ at tournaments: Cal Berkeley, Stanford, UCLA.

Leadership and extra curriculars

Speech and Debate | Public Forum Captain **August 2023 – May 2026**

- Grew membership by 350%, led a team of 50+ students as the Public Forum Captain(2 total)
- Achieved 5x TOC bids(T1 in event all time), ranked T70 nationally & T10 at California States.

Investment Club | President **August 2024 – May 2026**

- Grew membership 225%, directed 30+ individuals competing in Wharton Investment Competition
- Taught 60+ students investing principles: P/E ratio, portfolio diversity, simulations/debates/pitch

Skills and interests

Interests: Photography, Pickleball, Basketball, Video Games, Thrifting, Writing, Traveling, Cooking, Music
Skills: Word, Powerpoint, Video Editing, Photography, Teaching, Marketing, Market Research, Research